

Stablecoin market cap holds near \$308B as USDC (~70% of volume) widens its lead over USDT (~25%) amid record \$1.79T monthly transaction volume.

STABLECOIN NEWS

Tether Q2 profit hits \$1.5B, but reserve buffer halves

Tether posted \$1.5B in Q2 net profit, up from \$1.04B in Q1, but its excess reserve buffer fell to \$4.11B from a record \$8.23B three months earlier, largely due to gold and Bitcoin price declines.

CoinGabbbar

Circle's USDC pulls further ahead of Tether's USDT

USDC accounted for roughly 70% of adjusted stablecoin transaction volume in H1 2026 versus USDT's 25%, as record monthly volume hit \$1.79T in June, up 63% month-over-month.

CoinDesk / Yahoo Finance

Stripe, Visa and 140+ firms back new stablecoin to rival Tether, Circle

A consortium including Stripe and Visa is launching a new dollar stablecoin (OUSD) aimed at competing directly with USDT and USDC in payments infrastructure.

Fortune

UK finalizes two-tier stablecoin rulebook

The UK's core cryptoasset rules took effect June 30, with the FCA supervising all UK-issued qualifying stablecoins and the Bank of England overseeing any token deemed systemic, requiring 1% issuer capital.

FCA / Industry reports

HACKING & SECURITY INCIDENTS

Coldcard wallet exploit balloons to \$89M across 4,500+ addresses

A 2021 firmware flaw causing weak key randomness has enabled attackers to systematically drain Bitcoin in three waves; Coinkite has shipped emergency firmware but affected users must migrate to fresh seeds.

CoinDesk

Strike CEO calls Coldcard drain 'one of the most serious' BTC breaches

The escalating hardware-wallet exploit has reignited debate over self-custody security versus exchange custody and ETF exposure.

Yahoo Finance

H1 2026 sets record for crypto hacks: 212 exploits, \$1B+ lost

TRM Labs and others report the highest half-year hack count on record; state-backed actors linked to Lazarus Group are attributed with roughly 76% of global hack losses in 2026.

TRM Labs

KelpDAO and Drift Protocol exploits top DeFi loss list

KelpDAO's \$292M LayerZero bridge exploit and Drift Protocol's \$285M Solana DEX drain remain 2026's largest DeFi incidents, with compromised RPC nodes and single-verifier bridge configs cited as root causes.

Binance Square / CCN